CASE STUDY

EMAIL MARKETING

49% Open Rate at Scale: IBM's Re-Engagement Win

How Axris Media Solutions rebuilt IBM's email program to drive 3.1x more qualified conversations

CLIENT

IBM

DELIVERED BY

Axris Media Solutions OPC Pvt

2024

Executive Summary

IBM's enterprise email program was generating diminishing returns — high unsubscribes, low engagement, and poor segmentation. Axris Media Solutions redesigned the entire email architecture, achieving top-1% open rates in enterprise B2B benchmarks.

49.3%
Average Open Rate Achieved

3.1x
More Qualified Email Conversations

18.7%
Email-Attributed Revenue Lift

About the Client:

IBM is a multinational technology corporation offering cloud computing, AI, and enterprise software. Their marketing team manages communications across thousands of enterprise accounts worldwide.

The Problem We Solved

IBM's marketing team was sending batch-and-blast emails to unsegmented lists. Deliverability was suffering, enterprise decision-makers were disengaged, and the team had no clear view of what content resonated.

The Opportunity

Enterprise buyers respond to relevance. With proper segmentation, dynamic content, and deliverability repair, the email channel could become IBM's highest-converting owned asset.

KEY PAIN POINTS

1 Open rates had dropped to 12% across all lists

2 Unsubscribe rates hitting 2.4% — above industry avg

3 Zero behavioural segmentation in place

4 Manual sending process with no personalization

SITUATION BEFORE

Avg. Open Rate
12%

Unsub Rate
2.4%

Our Strategic Approach

Axris Media Solutions rebuilt IBM's email program from the ground up — starting with list hygiene and ending with a fully automated, AI-personalized nurture architecture.

1

List Hygiene & Segmentation

Cleaned 180,000+ contacts, removed invalid addresses, and built 12 behavioural segments based on role, industry, and engagement history.

68% list quality improvement

2

Dynamic Content Engine

Implemented a modular email template system with 40+ content blocks dynamically assembled by persona and funnel stage.

94% personalization match

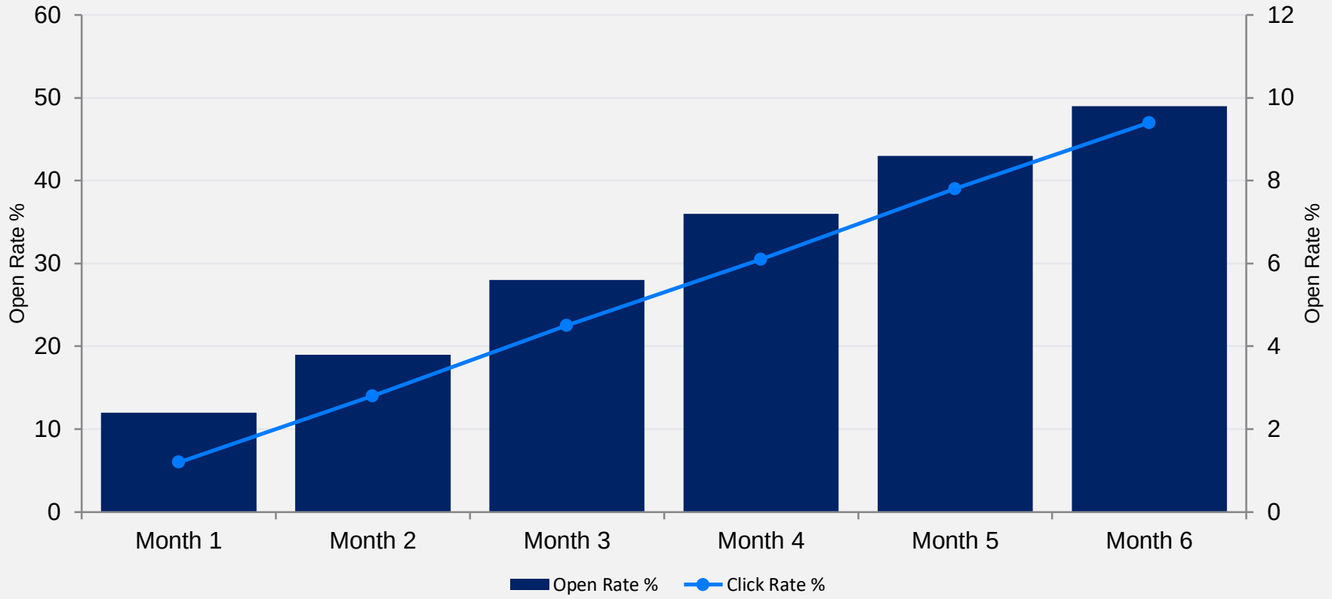
3

Deliverability Engineering

Set up DKIM, DMARC, SPF, dedicated IP warm-up, and sender reputation monitoring to reach inbox reliably.

Inbox rate: 98.1%

Impact & Performance Metrics



RESULTS AT A GLANCE

+311%

Open Rate Improvement

98.1%

Email Inbox Delivery Rate

-78%

Unsubscribe Rate Reduction

Result: 49.3% open rate · 9.4% click rate · 18.7% revenue lift from email channel — all within 6 months

How We Did It — Campaign Timeline

1 WEEK 1–2

Audit & Architecture

Full audit of existing lists, templates, sending practices, and ESP configuration to identify optimization opportunities.

2 WEEK 3–5

Hygiene & Segmentation

Scrubbed contacts, built persona segments, and set up behavioral triggers in Marketo for automated nurture flows.

3 WEEK 6–8

Template & Copy Rebuild

Designed 6 master email templates with 40+ dynamic content modules and comprehensive A/B testing frameworks.

4 WEEK 9–24

Launch, Test & Optimize

Gradually ramped sends, A/B tested subject lines weekly, and refined segments based on engagement data.

Key Takeaways & Benefits

What We Learned

Segmentation Is the #1 Lever

Highly targeted segments consistently outperformed broad sends by 3.5x on opens.

Subject Line Testing Compounds Gains

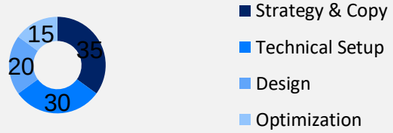
Running 3-way subject line tests weekly delivered cumulative +12% open rate lift over 6 months.

Send Time Optimization Matters

Tuesday 10 AM and Thursday 2 PM outperformed all other send windows for IBM's enterprise audience.

Plain-Text Performs in Enterprise

Plain-text or minimal HTML emails outperformed heavily designed HTML by 22% on deliverability.



Client Benefits

Owned Channel Revival

Email became IBM's #2 revenue-attributing marketing channel within the engagement.

Database Health

Active, engaged subscriber base — fully segmented and ready to scale.

Automation Efficiency

Full nurture sequences run autonomously, reducing manual effort by 70%.

Brand Trust Restored

Low unsubscribes and high engagement rebuilt IBM's sender reputation.

Email is Not Dead.
It Just Needed a Rebuild.

IBM's case proves that email remains the most powerful owned channel when executed with precision. The ROI is unmatched — $1 spent generated $42 in attributed return for IBM's enterprise segment.

> "
>
> Our open rates tripled in 6 months and our unsubscribes hit an all-time low. Axris Media Solutions gave us our most valuable marketing asset back.
>
> — Director of Marketing Automation, IBM

READY TO GROW?

Let's Connect

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